OCD-06 | For therapists | OCD, ages 8 and over

Barriers, covert rituals and applying learning elsewhere

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Explore a specific barrier with the therapist, including mental checking, reassurance seeking, avoidance or ritual substitution. The goal is formulation and adaptation of an existing plan, without constant thought monitoring.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

A silent action or religious practice is not necessarily a ritual. Assess function and context; do not cancel a religious obligation, medical care or safety measure based on a form. Do not search for every possible ritual or report every thought.

Reusing existing material

Unit 2 describes an initial cycle; here explore barriers to an existing plan and changes in a new context. A general flexible-thinking questionnaire does not replace this inquiry.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Noam reports mentally repeating a phrase during treatment work to feel certain. The therapist explores its function without assuming every repeated phrase is a ritual, then jointly identifies needed adjustments.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

Mindful Path

OCD-06 | For therapists | OCD, ages 8 and over

Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What makes the plan difficult in the chosen context?

2 | Question for discussion

What overt or covert response may maintain the cycle?

3 | Question for discussion

How will we distinguish real need, personal values and certainty seeking here?

4 | Question for discussion

What response substitution or context dependence emerged?

5 | Question for discussion

What needs professional assessment before changing the plan?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

Difficulty recognizing a covert response does not justify repeated questioning. Record a sufficient example and explore its function. Uncertainty about need, custom or ritual remains for context-sensitive professional assessment.

Mindful Path

OCD-06 | For therapists | OCD, ages 8 and over

Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children aged 8–11 only

Ages 8–11 only. Read one question and allow brief or spoken answers. Parents add separate observations without deciding the child's thoughts; do not test reporting accuracy. Thought content can remain unwritten.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Ages 12–17. Agree what stays private and what is shared with family or school, subject to safeguarding duties. Embarrassing thought content need not be disclosed. Do not make reporting covert responses a condition of trust.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Connect work to chosen goals, family, employment and existing care. Distinguish rituals, practical needs and value-consistent behavior. For religious concerns, arrange consultation with an appropriate person by consent if useful.

OA | Older adults

Preserve adult language, choice and privacy. Assess access, health and desired support without automatically attributing new changes to OCD or assuming reduced ability. Medical protections and access aids remain until appropriate assessment.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

Mindful Path

OCD-06 | For therapists | OCD, ages 8 and over

Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

The P sheet proposes recording decisions and learning within treatment, not ERP instructions. The therapist determines suitability, action, scope and support. Without an agreed plan, use only for discussion. Do not begin exposure or change response prevention based on this sheet.

At the next session

Check whether understanding is more accurate and recording remains limited. Plan or context changes require the therapist, not independent expansion prompted by a form question.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

Treatment-manual mapping status

Mapping against a full OCD manual and professional approval remain pending. This is original support material for review, not an approved ERP manual or its replacement.

www.nice.org.uk/guidance/cg31/chapter/Recommendations
iocdf.org/about-ocd/ocd-treatment-guide/erp/
kids.iocdf.org/professionals/md/treatment/

Mindful Path